(Holston 2007). As opposed to a statist citizenship that assumes the state as 'the only legitimate source of citizenship rights, meanings and practices' (Holston 1998:39), this alternative conceptualisation of citizenship is active, engaged, and 'grounded in civil society' (Friedmann 2002:76). It moves beyond formal citizenship to a substantive one that concerns an array of civil, political, social and economic rights. These demands include the right to housing, shelter, education and basic health. As such, it incorporates the notion of the 'right to the city' (Lefebre 1967), which recognises all city residents as 'rights holders' in the city, defending the needs and desires of the majority and affirming the city as a site for social conflict.

While 'the right to the city' has been recognised by the institutional framework in Brazil, the hollowing out of the functions of the institutional spaces for citizen participation by neoliberal reforms has left many of the promises unfulfilled (Santos Junior et al. 2011). The new generation of civil society movements has claimed the concept of the right to the city for its own, and it was frequently seen on banners and posters during the June protests. As emphasised by David Harvey, the right to the city is 'far more than a right of individual or group access to the resources the city embodies: it is the right to change and reinvent the city more after our hearts' desire' (Harvey 2012:4).

The right to the city has become a slogan for movements worldwide who fight against the manifestations of many modern cities in which public processes and utilities have been privatised and where development is driven primarily, if not solely, by corporations and markets. In protesting these tendencies, practices of insurgent citizenship have become the means through which the urban margins negotiate and contest their right to universal inclusion (Holston 2007:22). The Comitê Popular da Copa e das Olimpíadas – People's Committee of the World Cup and Olympics – is one example. The committee links established NGOs and social movements with favela communities that are threatened by evictions because of public works linked to the mega-sports events. Also, within the favelas residents have found ways of taking part in local decision-making processes. Residents' associations in several favelas have been revitalised by threats of removal, and local actors have been able to link up with external political events such as the Rio+20 conference and the People's Summit in June 2012 and other public legal forums dedicated to the defence of citizens' rights. The June protests sparked a new wave of social mobilisation, allowing local communities' struggles over localised issues to connect to a wider discourse of urban development conflicts in Rio de Janeiro and globally.